KinPath Year 1 Execution Plan

Prepared for: Mariesa Welcome
Location: Atlanta, Georgia
Purpose: A practical 12-month plan to validate, build, launch, and prepare KinPath for Year 2 growth.

Executive Summary

Year 1 should be treated as a **validation-and-foundation year**, not a scale year. The goal is to prove that Georgia families will use KinPath, that trusted local partners will refer people to it, that users will pay for the right level of support, and that the product can operate safely before significant investment in a full enterprise platform.

The highest-leverage outcome by the end of Year 1 is not a large download number. It is a working Georgia MVP, 100–300 activated family cases, a small trusted local referral network, at least one hospice pilot or formal design-partner relationship, evidence of willingness to pay, and enough data to decide what Year 2 investment is justified.

> **Year 1 mantra: Build trust first. Prove value second. Scale only after the evidence is undeniable.**

1. Year 1 Outcomes

By the end of the first 12 months, KinPath should have achieved the following:

Area	Year 1 Target	Why It Matters
Customer discovery	75–100 structured interviews	Ensures you build around real needs—not assumptions
Prototype testing	20–30 usability tests	Finds confusing language, missing workflows, and unwanted features before expensive development
MVP	Georgia-only working product	Keeps legal, content, and operational complexity manageable
Family cases	100–300 activated cases	Produces behavioral evidence, testimonials, and product insight
Early paid use	20–60 paid family packages or add-ons	Tests willingness to pay without subscriptions
Referral ecosystem	15–25 vetted providers/coordinators; 5–10 active referrers	Builds low-cost, high-trust acquisition channels
Hospice validation	1 formal pilot, design partnership, letter of intent, or defined referral agreement	Starts institutional proof without depending on long enterprise sales cycles
Content	25–40 Georgia-specific high-intent pages/articles	Builds visibility around urgent post-death questions

Area	Year 1 Target	Why It Matters
Legal/compliance	Core product and business policies reviewed	Avoids legal-advice, funeral-arranging, privacy, and disclosure mistakes
Product metrics	Baseline activation, completion, conversion, support, and satisfaction data	Gives you an evidence-based Year 2 plan
Cash runway	At least 9–12 months remaining	Protects the company from rushed decisions and bad financing

2. Year 1 Budget

A disciplined Year 1 investment range is **$90,000 to $220,000** when you use a lean build approach, personally lead product discovery and sales, and avoid custom development or premature enterprise compliance.

A fully outsourced custom application through a large agency can exceed $300,000–$500,000 before demand is proven. That is not the recommended path for Year 1.

Expense Category	Lean Validation Path	Recommended Path	Higher-Cost Path	What It Covers
Company formation, contracts, trademark review	$4,000	$8,000–$15,000	$25,000+	Georgia entity, operating agreement, privacy policy, terms, vendor/referral agreements, initial trademark clearance and counsel
Georgia legal/compliance review	$5,000	$12,000–$25,000	$50,000+	Legal-information boundaries, funeral-rule posture, data handling, vendor disclosures, referrals, content review
Customer discovery and research	$2,000	$5,000–$10,000	$20,000	Incentives, travel, recording/transcription, research tools, community outreach
Brand, UX design, and prototype	$5,000	$12,000–$25,000	$60,000+	Brand basics, website, clickable prototype, usability tests, design system
MVP development	$30,000–$60,000	$65,000–$120,000	$200,000+	Web-first MVP, case setup, checklist, roles, task coordination, basic secure document storage, resource directory, admin tools
Cloud, security, and software tools	$3,000	$8,000–$15,000	$35,000+	Hosting, authentication, database, backups, analytics, email/SMS, security monitoring, project tools
Content and SEO	$3,000	$8,000–$18,000	$40,000+	Georgia resource guides, editing, subject-matter review, landing pages, search optimization
Partner and vendor recruitment	$2,000	$5,000–$12,000	$25,000+	Outreach, local meetings, vetting, onboarding, community events
Marketing tests	$3,000	$8,000–$15,000	$50,000+	Small paid-search tests, local sponsorships, referral collateral—not mass advertising

Expense Category	Lean Validation Path	Recommended Path	Higher-Cost Path	What It Covers
Customer support and operations	$5,000	$12,000–$25,000	$60,000+	Part-time operations/support, trauma-informed communication training, resource accuracy
Contingency	$8,000	$15,000–$25,000	$50,000+	Unplanned legal, security, technical, or operations work
Total	**$70,000–$120,000**	**$158,000–$302,000**	**$615,000+**	—

Recommended Investment Target

Plan for approximately **$175,000–$225,000 in Year 1**, excluding your personal living expenses.

This is enough to build a credible, secure, web-first Georgia MVP; obtain necessary legal and compliance guidance; conduct strong customer research; recruit local partners; test early monetization; and avoid cutting corners on trust.

A leaner version may be possible around **$90,000–$125,000** if you:

- Build web-first rather than separate native iOS and Android apps.
- Use low-code tools for the early prototype and internal operations.
- Start with a narrow document-storage function or secure links instead of a complex vault.
- Personally lead discovery, partnerships, content coordination, and early customer support.
- Hire fractional specialists rather than full-time staff.
- Launch with one core family workflow rather than every desired feature.

Do Not Cut These Costs

Do not save money by skipping:

- Legal review.
- Data-security fundamentals.
- Consent and privacy design.
- Vendor fee-disclosure rules.
- User research.
- Trauma-informed customer-support practices.

These are areas where a shortcut can become an expensive failure.

3. What to Purchase

Business and Legal Foundation

Purchase or Service	Purpose	Priority
Georgia business entity formation	Establishes the company and ownership structure	Immediate
Operating agreement and founder-equity documentation	Protects founder ownership and clarifies decision rights	Immediate
Business bank account and bookkeeping platform	Separates business and personal funds	Immediate
Federal EIN	Needed for banking, payroll, contracts, and tax administration	Immediate
Domain name and company email suite	Secures brand identity and professional communication	Immediate
Trademark clearance and initial legal opinion	Determines whether KinPath can be used safely	Immediate
Privacy policy, terms of use, and consent language	Defines customer expectations and data practices	Before beta
Vendor listing and referral agreement templates	Creates consistent, disclosed partner relationships	Before directory launch
Independent contractor agreements	Protects confidential information and ownership of work	Before hiring contractors
Insurance consultation	Identifies general, cyber, and professional liability needs	Before public launch

Product and Operations Stack

Category	Recommended Type of Tool	Why You Need It
Company email and documents	Google Workspace or Microsoft 365	Professional email, shared documents, role-based administration
Domain and website hosting	Reputable domain registrar and managed host	Public site, secure landing pages, brand ownership
Project management	Linear, Asana, ClickUp, or Notion	Product backlog, launch timeline, partner tasks, accountability
Design and prototyping	Figma	Clickable prototypes and usability testing before coding
Customer research	Zoom, Calendly, transcription tool, secure note repository	Interviews, recordings, research synthesis
Product analytics	Privacy-conscious analytics platform	Activation, task completion, abandonment, retention, conversion
CRM	HubSpot Starter, Pipedrive, or similar	Tracks hospice, vendor, coordinator, employer, and advisor outreach

Category	Recommended Type of Tool	Why You Need It
Customer support	Shared inbox and support-ticket tool	Sensitive support requests should not live in a personal inbox
Secure authentication	MFA-capable authentication provider with role controls	Protects family and administrator accounts
Cloud hosting	AWS, Google Cloud, or secure managed platform	Hosting, databases, file storage, backups, monitoring
File storage	Encrypted, access-controlled storage	Family documents may be highly sensitive
Password manager	1Password, Bitwarden, or equivalent	Reduces avoidable credential risk
E-signature	DocuSign, Dropbox Sign, or equivalent	Partner, vendor, contractor, and pilot agreements
Accounting	QuickBooks, Xero, or equivalent	Cash management, invoicing, expenses, investor-grade records
SMS/email provider	Transactional messaging platform	Reminders, invitations, and deadline communications
Video conferencing	Zoom or Teams	Interviews, partner meetings, team collaboration

Do Not Buy in Year 1

Avoid the following until actual data proves the need:

- Separate native iOS and Android applications.
- A nationwide funeral-home marketplace.
- Payment processing for funeral services.
- An AI legal-advice product.
- Full insurer claims-processing integrations.
- Hospital EHR integrations.
- An expensive office.
- A large advertising campaign.
- A national sales team.
- Custom CRM or custom analytics software.
- A broad multi-state legal-content library.
- A premium brand campaign before customer proof exists.

4. Year 1 Sequence

Quarter 1: Validate the Problem

Primary goal: Understand the actual work, fear, conflict, and decision points KinPath must solve before writing expensive code.

What to Do

1. Form the company and separate business and personal finances.
2. Secure a domain, professional email, shared document system, and simple landing page.
3. Conduct preliminary trademark clearance for KinPath before public branding.
4. Recruit an advisory circle:
    - Hospice bereavement leader.
    - Social worker or grief-support professional.
    - Georgia estate/probate attorney.
    - Funeral-industry professional.
    - Privacy/security advisor.
    - Enterprise SaaS or benefits-sales advisor.
    - Faith and cultural advisors for the initial pathways.
5. Complete the first 30–40 interviews.
6. Map the full Georgia journey from immediate death through one year.
7. Identify the 10 most painful moments, 10 most common tasks, and 10 highest-risk family conflict moments.
8. Build a clickable prototype—not a full app.
9. Test the prototype with 10–15 people.
10. Choose the exact MVP scope based on evidence, not the largest wish list.

Quarter 1 Deliverables

- One-page KinPath thesis.
- Defined ideal first user: a designated next of kin in Georgia.
- Defined initial buyer hypothesis: direct families plus local referral partners, then hospice.
- Customer journey map.
- Top-10 pain-point report.
- Product requirements document.
- Clickable prototype.
- First draft of privacy, consent, and vendor-disclosure principles.
- Initial financial model and 12-month cash plan.
- Target list of 50 local partners.

Quarter 2: Build the Narrow MVP

Primary goal: Launch a private beta that helps a small group of families complete real work.

Build Only These Functions

1. Case Setup

- Basic family and deceased-person profile.
- Date and location of death.
- Georgia-focused pathways.
- Asset categories.
- Optional faith/cultural pathway.
- Funeral status.

2. Checklist and Timeline

- Immediate, first-week, first-month, claims, estate, and first-year phases.
- Editable tasks.
- “Not applicable” and “complete” options.
- Task ownership.
- Due dates and reminders.

3. Family Collaboration

- One coordinator.
- Up to 4–5 helpers.
- Clear helper roles.
- Invitations.
- Task assignment.
- Access revocation.
- Basic audit history.

4. Resource Center

- Official Georgia and federal links.
- Attorney-referral resources.
- SSA, VA, IRS, probate, life-insurance, retirement-account, property, and mortgage checklists.
- Plain-language disclaimer: general information only, not legal or financial advice.

5. Basic Secure Documents

- Controlled document uploads or secure links.
- Per-document access controls.
- Download and activity history.

6. Basic Directory

- Funeral homes.
- Florists.
- Caterers.
- Death doulas and independent coordinators.
- Community grief resources.
- Transparent fee disclosures.

7. Founder/Admin Dashboard

- Resource management.
- Vendor approval.
- Support-request review.
- Activity and onboarding tracking.

Quarter 2 Partner Work

- Recruit 15–25 local directory listings.
- Identify 5–10 death doulas or independent coordinators.
- Meet 10 hospice leaders.
- Meet 10 estate/probate attorneys and benefits professionals for resource-feedback sessions.
- Create a clear “Why Refer KinPath?” partner sheet.
- Establish a code of conduct and vetting checklist for listed vendors.

Quarter 2 Success Threshold

Do not launch broadly until at least 10–20 target users can:

- Complete onboarding.
- Understand the next action.
- Invite a helper.
- Find a relevant resource.

They should be able to do this without heavy founder assistance.

Quarter 3: Run a Controlled Beta

Primary goal: Determine whether KinPath creates enough real relief and task-completion behavior to justify broader investment.

Beta Design

- Enroll 50–100 family cases.
- Start with referrals from people you can personally support.
- Do not market aggressively until support processes are stable.
- Offer free access to selected early design partners in exchange for structured feedback.
- Test one-time paid packages with a smaller group.

Suggested Price Tests

Offer	Test Price	What It Tests
Free starter roadmap	$0	Activation and trust
Family coordination package	$99	Baseline willingness to pay
Enhanced family package	$149–$199	Value of vault, collaboration, reminders, and directory access
Guided setup or concierge add-on	$99–$299	Demand for human assistance
Partner-sponsored access	Free to the family	Institutional distribution and referral friction

Do not make price the primary question during an emotionally acute moment. First make the product helpful. Test pricing clearly, ethically, and without trapping anyone in a subscription.

Quarter 3 Metrics

Metric	Early Target
Started cases completing onboarding	60%+
Activated cases completing at least three priority tasks in seven days	40%+
Cases completing meaningful first-month tasks	50%+
Cases inviting at least one helper	50%+
Families using the resource center	60%+
Families reporting reduced confusion	70%+
Families willing to recommend KinPath	50%+
Serious privacy or trust incidents	0
Vendor fee-disclosure completion	100%
Response to urgent support issue	Same business day whenever possible

Quarter 4: Convert Proof into Repeatability

Primary goal: Turn beta evidence into a repeatable Year 2 engine.

What to Do

1. Analyze which users activated and why.
2. Identify the exact moment users say, “This helped me.”
3. Remove features that did not matter.
4. Improve onboarding and the first seven days.
5. Create 3–5 case studies with written permission and privacy protection.
6. Formalize the partner referral process.
7. Convert the strongest hospice or community organization into a design partnership, low-cost pilot, letter of intent, or referral agreement with defined measurement.
8. Build a Year 2 buyer deck for employers/EAPs and regional insurers.
9. Review cash runway and decide whether to bootstrap, seek grants, seek strategic pilot funding, raise a small pre-seed round, or use revenue to fund the next stage.
10. Decide whether Georgia remains the only state for Year 2.

Quarter 4 Deliverables

- MVP Version 2 roadmap based on evidence.
- Customer and partner case studies.
- Standard partner agreement.
- Vendor agreement and disclosure policy.
- Security and privacy improvement plan.
- Updated unit-economics model.
- Year 2 operating plan.
- Institutional sales deck.
- Organized data room containing contracts, financials, product metrics, legal documents, and partner evidence.

5. Customer Interview Plan

You need interviews with five groups:

1. Recently bereaved family members who served as next of kin.
2. Hospice bereavement staff and social workers.
3. Death doulas and independent funeral coordinators.
4. Funeral homes and other local service providers.

5. Estate/probate attorneys, financial professionals, employers, EAP leaders, and benefits professionals.

Do not begin interviews by pitching KinPath. Start by learning actual behavior, emotions, workarounds, failures, and decisions.

Interview Rules

- Ask about a real past event, not hypothetical future preferences.
- Ask “What did you do?” instead of “Would you use?”
- Ask for examples, paperwork, notes, calendars, or workarounds where appropriate.
- Avoid leading questions such as, “Wouldn’t it be helpful if…?”
- Ask permission before recording.
- Do not pressure grieving people to share beyond their comfort level.
- Offer a respectful participant incentive where appropriate, such as a $25–$75 gift card or charitable donation.
- Keep bereaved-family interviews to 30–45 minutes unless the participant chooses otherwise.
- Use trauma-informed communication: participants may pause, skip questions, or end at any time.

6. Family Interview Questions

Opening and Context

1. Please tell me about the period after your loved one died, only to the extent you are comfortable.
2. What role did you personally take on in the family?
3. Were you primarily responsible for decisions, paperwork, money, funeral arrangements, or communication?
4. What happened in the first 24 hours?
5. What was the first task that felt confusing or overwhelming?

Journey and Pain Points

6. Walk me through the first week after the death.
7. What did you need to do that you did not know how to do?
8. Which tasks took more time than you expected?
9. What information did you struggle to find?
10. What did you wish someone had told you earlier?
11. What deadlines worried you?

12. Which organizations did you have to contact?
13. What forms, documents, passwords, accounts, or records were hardest to locate?
14. Did you have to coordinate funeral, benefits, property, insurance, banking, or legal matters at the same time?
15. Which task caused the greatest emotional stress?
16. Which task caused the greatest financial stress?

Family Coordination and Conflict

17. Who helped you, if anyone?
18. How did the family communicate about responsibilities?
19. Did group texts, calls, emails, or in-person conversations work well?
20. Were there disagreements about money, funeral decisions, property, responsibility, or authority?
21. Did anyone feel excluded, overloaded, mistrusted, or uninformed?
22. How did you decide who could see financial information or documents?
23. Were there tasks that multiple people thought someone else was handling?
24. If you could redesign the family coordination process, what would you change?

Tools and Workarounds

25. What tools did you use—paper folders, notes app, spreadsheets, email, text messages, calendars, shared drives, funeral-home portals, or something else?
26. What worked well about those tools?
27. What did not work?
28. Did you search online for help? What did you search for?
29. Which websites, services, professionals, or organizations were useful?
30. Which were confusing, expensive, unhelpful, or untrustworthy?

Product Validation

31. If one secure family workspace had existed, what would it have needed to do for you to use it?
32. What would have made you distrust an app like that?
33. Would you want family members to have different permissions? Why?
34. Would a shared expense ledger have helped? Why or why not?
35. Would a decision log have helped? Which decisions should require acknowledgment?
36. What documents would you have stored securely?
37. What reminders would have been helpful, and which reminders would have felt intrusive?
38. What would make the app feel compassionate rather than transactional?

39. At what point would you have been willing to pay for help?
40. What would have been a fair one-time price for a service that meaningfully reduced your burden?

Closing

41. What did I fail to ask that matters?
42. May I contact you for feedback on a prototype later?
43. Do you know anyone else who had a similar responsibility and might be willing to speak with me?

7. Hospice and Bereavement Interview Questions

1. How does your organization currently support families after a patient dies?
2. How long does bereavement follow-up usually continue?
3. What support do families most often need but do not receive?
4. What questions come up repeatedly in the first week, first month, and first year?
5. What administrative tasks consume staff time?
6. How do you currently share resource lists, referrals, forms, and follow-up information?
7. What happens when a family is overwhelmed or in conflict?
8. Would a family coordination tool help your team? Under what conditions?
9. What would make you reluctant to recommend a third-party platform?
10. What security, privacy, contracting, or brand requirements would you need?
11. What metrics would convince leadership that a pilot worked?
12. Would you prefer a no-cost referral tool, paid license, per-family access, or sponsored model?
13. How would a referral fit into your existing workflow?
14. Who else would need to approve a partnership?
15. What would make KinPath feel like support to your team rather than more work?

8. Death Doula and Coordinator Interview Questions

1. Describe the work you do from the first call through follow-up.
2. Where do families struggle most?
3. Which tasks do families fail to complete?
4. How do you currently track tasks, family decisions, expenses, and documents?
5. Do family disagreements interfere with your work?
6. Would a shared family workspace make your work easier or harder?

7. What permissions would you need as a helper or professional?
8. What information should never be visible to everyone?
9. Would you refer clients to KinPath? What would you need to trust it?
10. How should a referral relationship work ethically?
11. What pricing or compensation structure would feel fair and transparent?
12. What local providers do families most need help finding?
13. What are warning signs that a provider is not trustworthy?
14. Would you participate in a design-partner group?

9. Funeral Home and Vendor Interview Questions

1. What questions do families ask repeatedly after a death?
2. At what point do families become most overwhelmed?
3. What do you currently provide beyond funeral arrangements?
4. Would a family coordination tool help your staff or create complications?
5. What information would you be willing to provide in a transparent directory?
6. How do you currently handle pricing transparency?
7. Would you accept a free or low-cost basic directory listing?
8. Would you pay a fixed, disclosed enhanced-listing fee? Why or why not?
9. What would make you reject a platform partnership?
10. How should KinPath distinguish vendors fairly?
11. What complaints or concerns do families raise most often?
12. What data would you never want a platform to collect or display?

10. Employer, EAP, and Benefits Interview Questions

1. What bereavement benefits do you currently offer?
2. Where do employees need the most help after a loss?
3. What burden does bereavement create for HR, managers, EAPs, payroll, or benefits teams?
4. How do you know whether your current support works?
5. What outcome would justify adding a bereavement-navigation product?
6. Would you prefer a per-employee model, utilization-based model, or fixed annual license?
7. What privacy safeguards would be required?
8. What implementation, branding, reporting, or integration requirements would matter?
9. Who owns the budget for this type of benefit?
10. What evidence would you need before piloting KinPath?

11. What would make you choose KinPath instead of an existing benefits provider?
12. How would you define a successful 90-day pilot?

11. Georgia Estate and Probate Attorney Questions

1. What are the most common mistakes families make after a death?
2. Which misconceptions create the greatest delay or cost?
3. What information can a software product safely provide without crossing into legal advice?
4. Which government forms, deadlines, and directories are appropriate for a general resource tool?
5. What disclaimers or workflow boundaries would you require?
6. Which information varies most by county or case type?
7. What should KinPath never automate?
8. Would an attorney-referral directory be useful? What quality criteria should apply?
9. How should the product route a family to legal counsel?
10. Would you join a limited advisory review group?

12. Recruiting Interview Participants

Families

- Partner with grief-support organizations, faith communities, bereavement groups, and trusted social workers.
- Ask death doulas, attorneys, and funeral homes for permission-based referrals.
- Use neutral language: “We are researching ways to reduce the administrative burden families face after a death.”
- Do not scrape obituaries or cold-contact recently bereaved people.
- Do not use emotionally manipulative advertising.

Partners

- Build a target list of Atlanta and Georgia organizations.
- Send a short message focused on learning, not sales.
- Ask for 20–30 minutes.
- Offer to share anonymized findings from the research.
- Follow up consistently but respectfully.

Sample Outreach Message

> Hello [Name],
> I am developing KinPath, a Georgia-based family coordination tool intended to help the person responsible after a death manage tasks, documents, deadlines, and family communication with less confusion and conflict.
> I am not asking you to buy anything. I am conducting a short research conversation to understand what families and professionals genuinely need, where existing support breaks down, and what a responsible solution would have to do well.
> Would you be open to a 25-minute conversation in the next two weeks? I would be grateful for your perspective, and I can share a summary of the non-identifying findings afterward.
> Thank you,
> Mariesa Welcome
> Founder, KinPath

13. How to Accomplish the Year 1 Goals

Monthly Founder Dashboard

Every month, track these five questions:

1. Are families activating and completing meaningful work?
2. Are people willing to pay or refer?
3. Which channel produces the highest-trust users?
4. What product feature produces the first moment of relief?
5. What legal, privacy, or operational risk did we discover and correct?

Decision Rules

Use these rules to avoid wasting money:

- If fewer than 40% of beta users reach a meaningful first action, fix onboarding before buying more marketing.
- If users activate but do not return, improve the checklist, reminders, and task ownership before adding features.
- If families love the product but will not pay, test packaging and referral models before assuming there is no product value.
- If a partner praises the idea but will not refer families, identify workflow friction before building enterprise features.
- If vendors want visibility but resist transparent disclosures, do not compromise the brand to include them.
- If hospitals require complex compliance or integrations, defer them.

- If you personally handle every customer-support issue, pause growth and strengthen operations.
- If Georgia requires more content or legal nuance than expected, do not expand to a second state.

Founder Operating Commitment

Weekly Activity	Minimum Commitment
Customer or family interviews	5
Partner conversations	5
Product-usability observations	2
Direct asks for a pilot, referral, or introduction	10
Product-metrics review	1 weekly session
Resource and compliance review	1 scheduled session
Founder reflection and decision journal	30–60 minutes
Personal recovery time	Non-negotiable block

14. Year 1 Win Definition

A successful first year is not a flashy launch. It is a small, credible, secure product that real Georgia families use during a difficult moment; that local professionals feel comfortable recommending; and that future institutional buyers recognize as a serious, measurable solution.

By the end of Year 1, you should be able to answer clearly:

- Who activates KinPath?
- Why do they activate?
- What feature gives them the first moment of relief?
- Which channel brings the best users?
- Will families pay for meaningful coordination help?
- What does a referral partner gain?
- What does it cost to support one family case?
- What evidence would make an employer, hospice, or insurer sign a pilot?

If you can answer those questions with real evidence, KinPath will enter Year 2 with a foundation that most early-stage companies never achieve.